

Cambodian Riel Banknote Version Checklist for Denomination Detection

Scope and source hierarchy

This checklist is designed to be an **authoritative comparison target** for your later local dataset audit, not a claim about what your dataset already contains. I treated the **National Bank of Cambodia's current banknote gallery** as the source of truth for which modern note families remain official/current, then used **Numista, BanknoteDB, Wikipedia/Wikimedia**, and the **Currency of Cambodia** catalog to extract front/back descriptions, visual differences, and reference-image links. ¹

One important practical point: collectors often split Cambodian notes by **print year, signature pair, replacement status, or specimen status**, even when the **main front/back design family is effectively the same**. For a CashSnap-style detector, that usually matters far less than whether the **layout, portrait, temple, bridge, or commemorative scene** is different. I therefore use **design-family rows** rather than every catalog micro-variant. ²

I also kept the main table focused on **second-riel banknotes and near-modern edge cases**. Earlier **first-riel** collector material does exist, including old **500-riel** and **1,000-riel** banknotes, plus a **non-issued 5,000-riel banknote from 1974**; meanwhile the Khmer Republic **10,000** and **50,000 riel** pieces of 1974 were **coins, not banknotes**. Those are not practical CashSnap targets unless you expect museum, dealer, or collector images. ³

Status labels used below:

"NBC current list" means the note family appears on the National Bank of Cambodia's official **Banknotes in Circulation** page. That is a strong statement about legal/current status, but it is **not** the same thing as a published count of how common each version is in everyday street circulation. I did **not** find a reliable source with by-version field prevalence, so priority recommendations combine **official current status, issue recency, and visual distinctness**. ⁴

KHR version checklist

Denomination	Version / year	Circulation status	Include / priority	Front visual signs	Back visual signs	Dominant color / size
500	1991 State of Cambodia	Obsolete / demonetized	No — can ignore	Arms above Angkor Wat ; older large-format layout	Animal statue at left and cultivation/tractors scene	Color not reliably cataloged; 149×71
500	1995 family	NBC current list older standard	Yes — nice to include	Angkor Wat only on front; no portrait	Rice fields reverse	Color not reliably cataloged; 133×62
500	2002 design, issued 2003	NBC current list older standard	Yes — must include	Angkor Wat front	Kizuna Bridge over the Mekong	Red / p; 138×64
500	2014 design, issued 2015	NBC current list current standard	Yes — must include	Naga, Royal Arms, King Norodom Sihamoni	Neak Loeung Bridge, Kizuna Bridge, Bayon relief, Japanese-Cambodian Friendship Monument	Red / p; gray; 138 mm
1,000	1992 State of Cambodia	Not issued	No — can ignore	Bayon temple ruins	Fishermen in boats with large nets	Color not reliably cataloged; 157×75

Denomination	Version / year	Circulation status	Include / priority	Front visual signs	Back visual signs	Dominant color / size
1,000	1995 family	NBC current list older standard	Yes — nice to include	Four faces of Avalokiteśvara from Bayon / Angkor	Royal Palace / Chanchhaya	Color not reliably cataloged; 128×67
1,000	1999 family	NBC current list older standard	Yes — nice to include	Bayon temple complex	Construction site with modern bridge in background	Color not reliably cataloged; 138×64
1,000	2005 design, issued 2006	NBC current list older standard	Yes — must include	Southern gate at Bayon	Autonomous Port of Kampong Saom / Sihanoukville	Brown; 138×64
1,000	2012 commemorative, issued 2013	NBC current list circulating commemorative	Yes — must include	Late King Norodom Sihanouk memorial portrait and memorial text	Golden swan-shaped funeral float passing the Royal Palace Throne Hall	Blue-violet memorial palette; 138×64
1,000	2016 design, issued 2017	NBC current list current standard	Yes — must include	Naga head, royal monogram, youthful King Norodom Sihanouk	Royal Palace Throne Hall, Kinnari, statue of former king on horseback	Purple; 142×68
2,000	1992 State of Cambodia	Not issued	No — can ignore	Prince Norodom Sihanouk in suit with Preah Vihear gate ruins	Mostly denomination-focused reverse	Color not reliably cataloged; 156×73

Denomination	Version / year	Circulation status	Include / priority	Front visual signs	Back visual signs	Dominant color / size
2,000	1995 family	NBC current list older standard	Yes — nice to include	Fishermen on Tonlé Sap	Angkor Wat	Color not reliably cataloged; 128×67
2,000	2007 design, issued 2008	NBC current list older standard	Yes — must include	Preah Vihear ruins	Angkor Wat with field workers harvesting rice	Green / black / yellow; 146×68
2,000	2013 Independence commemorative	NBC current list circulating commemorative	Yes — must include	King Norodom Sihanouk, coat of arms, naga	Sihanouk leading troops across a river and the Independence Monument	Green; 146×68
2,000	2018 China-Cambodia commemorative	Cataloged as circulating commemorative	No — can ignore for denomination-only	Same main look as the Preah Vihear family	Same main look as the rice-harvest / Angkor Wat family	Green / black / yellow; 146×68
2,000	2022 family	NBC current list current standard	Yes — must include	Royal arms, naga, adult King Norodom Sihamoni	Ancient stone artifact, Prasat Tao, chinthe / king lion	Green / orange / black / brown / yellow; 146×68
5,000	1995 family	NBC current list older standard	Yes — nice to include	King Norodom Sihanouk at right, Banteay Srei at left	Central Market, Phnom Penh	Color not reliably cataloged; 138×67

Denomination	Version / year	Circulation status	Include / priority	Front visual signs	Back visual signs	Dominant color / size
5,000	2001 family	NBC current list older standard	Yes — must include	King Norodom Sihanouk + naga, predominantly green	Kampong Kdei bridge in Siem Reap Province	Predominant green; 142×68 mm
5,000	2015 design, issued 2017	NBC current list current standard	Yes — must include	King Sihanouk wearing beret, naga to left	Bridge and ox-cart relief	Violet / brown; 142×68 mm
10,000	1995 family	NBC current list older standard	Yes — nice to include	King Norodom Sihanouk at right, Lokecvara statue at left	People rowing long boat	Color not reliably in catalog; 138×67 mm
10,000	2001 family	NBC current list older standard	Yes — must include	King Norodom Sihanouk + naga	Water Festival scene in front of the Royal Palace	Color not reliably in catalog; 146×68 mm
10,000	2015 King Sihamoni birthday commemorative	NBC current list circulating commemorative	Yes — must include	Naga at left, King Norodom Sihamoni at right, central royal motif	Neak Pean ruins and Balaha horse statue	Color not reliably in catalog; 155×72 mm
20,000	1995 family	NBC current list older standard	Yes — nice to include	Port of Phnom Penh at left, King Norodom Sihanouk at right	Royal Palace throne room	Color not reliably in catalog; 147×67 mm

Denomination	Version / year	Circulation status	Include / priority	Front visual signs	Back visual signs	Dominant color / size
20,000	2008 family	NBC current list older standard	Yes — must include	King Norodom Sihamoni in royal regalia	Bayon temple complex / Avalokiteśvara-face architecture	Violet / purple; 150×70
20,000	2017 design, issued 2018	NBC current list circulating commemorative	Yes — must include	Bust of King Sihamoni, naga head, foil hologram strip	Library of Banteay Srei and stone guardian carving	Pink / gold; 155×72
50,000	1995 family	NBC current list older standard	Yes — nice to include	Preah Vihear at left, King Norodom Sihanouk at right	Preah Vihear temple district	Color not reliably cataloged; 147×67
50,000	2001 family	NBC current list older standard	Yes — must include	King Norodom Sihanouk portrait + naga head	Aerial view of Angkor Wat	Violet / brown; 150×70
50,000	2013 design, issued 2014	NBC current list current standard	Yes — must include	King Norodom Sihanouk, naga head, foil strip	Bakong temple ruins and baby elephant sculpture	Brown; 155×72

High-risk versions you should not miss

The biggest practical risk is not tiny signature differences. It is **missing an entire design family** that changes the note's dominant objects, portrait, or layout. These are the ones I would treat as most dangerous omissions in a denomination-only training set. ³³

- **500 riel:** the old **temple-front** families and the newer **portrait-front** family are drastically different. If you only train on one, the other is an obvious failure mode. ³⁴
- **1,000 riel:** you really need all three modern looks: **Bayon/port, funeral commemorative**, and **portrait + throne hall/Kinnari**. The 2012/2013 funeral note is especially easy to miss but visually unique. ³⁵

- **2,000 riel:** treat **Preah Vihear/rice harvest**, **Independence commemorative**, and **2022 lion/Sambo Prei Kuk** as separate visual families. The 2018 China-Cambodia commemorative is low-risk only because it closely matches the older Preah Vihear family. ³⁶
- **5,000 riel:** the **green 2001 family** and the **violet 2015/2017 beret family** should both be present. ³⁷
- **10,000 riel:** the **old Water Festival / Royal Palace family** and the **large-format 2015 birthday commemorative** are different enough that both matter. ³⁸
- **20,000 riel:** the **purple 2008 family** and the **pink 2017/2018 Banteay Srei commemorative** are a classic “same denomination, different note” pair. ³⁹
- **50,000 riel:** the **Angkor Wat reverse family** and the **Bakong / baby elephant family** should both be in scope. ⁴⁰
- **1995-era narrow-format notes** across several denominations are worth a special audit pass. NBC still lists them in circulation, but they are much older and visually unlike later issues. If your dataset was collected mostly from recent cash handling, they are the most likely current legal-tender families to be underrepresented. That last sentence is an inference from their age and official current status, not from a published by-version circulation count. ⁴¹

CashSnap v1 recommendation

Minimum version coverage needed

For a strong **v1 denomination detector**, I would make the minimum target set the visually distinct families most likely to matter in modern Cambodian cash handling:

- **500:** 2003 family + 2015 family. ⁴²
- **1,000:** 2006 family + 2013 funeral commemorative + 2017 family. ⁴³
- **2,000:** 2008 family + 2013 Independence commemorative + 2022 family. ⁴⁴
- **5,000:** 2001 family + 2017 family. ⁴⁵
- **10,000:** 2001 family + 2015 commemorative. ⁴⁶
- **20,000:** 2008 family + 2018 commemorative. ⁴⁷
- **50,000:** 2001 family + 2014 family. ⁴⁸

That gives you a version set that covers the main **portrait / temple / bridge / commemorative** shifts without forcing you to chase every older narrow-format note before launch. ³³

Versions that can be ignored safely

You can safely ignore these for a denomination-only CashSnap v1 unless you expect archival, collector, or catalog data:

- **500 riel 1991** because it is marked **demonetized**. ⁵
- **1,000 riel 1992** and **2,000 riel 1992** because they were **not issued**. ⁴⁹
- **2,000 riel 2018 China-Cambodia commemorative** if your task is **denomination detection only**, because its main front/back imagery is effectively the same family as the older 2,000 Preah Vihear/rice-harvest design. ⁵⁰
- **First-riel collector material** and the **1974 non-issued 5,000-riel note**, because they are not practical current-cash targets. ⁵¹

Versions that require custom collection

The public sources I found are excellent for **catalog scans** and **reference images**, but they are not a substitute for **in-the-wild smartphone photos** with folds, glare, fingers, blur, occlusion, dirty notes, and mixed backgrounds. That means you should expect to collect custom images for: **older 1995-era families**, **circulating commemoratives** like the **1,000 funeral**, **2,000 Independence**, **10,000 birthday**, and **20,000 birthday** notes, and any family you discover is absent from your local thumbnails. ⁵²

My strongest custom-collection priorities after v1 would be:

- all **1995-era current families** still listed by NBC, because they are legally current but likely harder to find in modern web-image sources; and
- all **circulating commemoratives**, because they are visually different enough to matter but easy to miss in denomination-only scraped datasets. That second point is an inference from their distinct official designs and the scan-heavy nature of public reference sources. ⁵³

Why missing versions hurt detection

When labels are **denomination-only** but the training set covers only one visual family for that denomination, the model can learn the wrong shortcut. For Cambodian riel, the same class can shift from **temple-only** to **portrait-centric**, from **bridge reverse** to **funeral float reverse**, or from a **purple standard design** to a **pink commemorative design**. That is a large visual domain shift inside the same class. ⁵⁴

In practice, that can show up as:

- **false negatives** when a held-out family looks nothing like the family the model memorized;
- **poorer robustness to partial views**, because a cropped bridge, naga, or palace detail may no longer match the model's dominant learned template; and
- **cross-denomination confusion** if one denomination is under-covered and another denomination has a superficially similar color or architectural motif.

Those performance effects are an inference from how visually different these official note families are, rather than a banknote-specific benchmark result. The underlying risk is real because the note families themselves are demonstrably different. ⁵⁵

Final thumbnail audit checklist

Use this as a fast manual pass over your dataset thumbnails. Every line below is framed as a **family-presence question**, not a claim that your dataset contains it.

- **500 riel**: do you have **old plain Angkor Wat** notes, **Angkor Wat + Kizuna Bridge** notes, and **portrait-front / two-bridge** notes? ³⁴
- **1,000 riel**: do you have **Bayon/port**, **funeral float commemorative**, and **portrait + throne-hall/ Kinnari** families? Also check whether any **older 1995/1999** narrow-format notes appear. ⁵⁶
- **2,000 riel**: do you have **Preah Vihear/rice harvest**, **Independence commemorative**, and **2022 lion/Sambo Prei Kuk** families? If you see a Preah Vihear/rice-harvest note, you probably do **not** need to split out the 2018 China-Cambodia commemorative for v1. ³⁶

- **5,000 riel:** do you have both the **green Kampong Kdei bridge** family and the **violet beret / ox-cart** family? ³⁷
- **10,000 riel:** do you have the **Water Festival / Royal Palace** family and the **Neak Pean / horse** commemorative family? ³⁸
- **20,000 riel:** do you have the **purple royal-regalia / Bayon** family and the **pink Banteay Srei** commemorative family? ³⁹
- **50,000 riel:** do you have the **Angkor Wat reverse** family and the **Bakong / baby elephant** family? Also check for any **old 1995 Preah Vihear** note if you want broader official-current coverage. ⁵⁷

Open questions and limitations

I did **not** find a reliable published source that says, for example, “the 2001 5,000-riel note is X times more common in daily circulation than the 1995 5,000-riel note.” So the **priority** column reflects the best practical synthesis of **official current status**, **issue recency**, and **visual distinctness**, not a measured street-frequency ranking. ⁴

A few catalog values, especially **dimensions** and sometimes **color wording**, disagree across sources. Where NBC publishes a size on its official current banknote page, I treated **NBC as authoritative**; where NBC does not list the note, I used Numista. For some older families, I deliberately wrote “**color not reliably cataloged**” rather than guess from scans. ⁵⁸

Finally, this report does **not** audit your local files. Every row therefore remains “**Need local dataset check: yes.**” The next step on your side is to compare your thumbnail sheets against the design-family cues above and mark which families are actually present, absent, or ambiguous.

1 4 6 7 8 10 11 12 13 14 16 17 18 20 21 22 23 24 25 26 27 28 29 30 31 32 41 42 43 44
45 46 47 48 53 58 Banknotes in Circulation

https://www.nbc.gov.kh/english/about_the_bank/banknotes_in_circulation.php

2 ³⁷ <https://en.numista.com/207716>
<https://en.numista.com/207716>

3 ⁵¹ <https://en.numista.com/catalogue/cambodge-2.html>
<https://en.numista.com/catalogue/cambodge-2.html>

5 <https://en.numista.com/209860>
<https://en.numista.com/209860>

9 ⁴⁹ <https://en.numista.com/217614>
<https://en.numista.com/217614>

15 2000 Riels (Not Issued) - Cambodia – Numista
<https://en.numista.com/217220>

19 ⁵⁰ <https://en.numista.com/327970>
<https://en.numista.com/327970>

33 ⁵⁴ <https://en.numista.com/201721>
<https://en.numista.com/201721>

34 <https://en.numista.com/204587>

<https://en.numista.com/204587>

35 <https://en.numista.com/201752>

<https://en.numista.com/201752>

36 <https://en.numista.com/207355>

<https://en.numista.com/207355>

38 <https://en.numista.com/211143>

<https://en.numista.com/211143>

39 <https://en.numista.com/206056>

<https://en.numista.com/206056>

40 <https://en.numista.com/207992>

<https://en.numista.com/207992>

52 https://banknotedb.com/?bank=428&country=117&curr_page=3&order=asc&sort=country

https://banknotedb.com/?bank=428&country=117&curr_page=3&order=asc&sort=country

55 <https://en.numista.com/215643>

<https://en.numista.com/215643>

56 <https://en.numista.com/217347>

<https://en.numista.com/217347>

57 <https://en.numista.com/211651>

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